



young girl in a bag left next to the railway track. But an FIR was registered only after the post-mortem report confirmed it as a case of murder. The GRP remains clueless about the girl's identity and is planning to label it as a "case untraced" in the court—a fate that such cases meet eventually.

Even in the cases where the body has been identified, the GRP invariably hits a dead-end when the victims' poor kin shy away from investigation. Take, for instance, the case of Rambir, a 30-year-old youth who was brutally murdered with a sharp-edged weapon. His body was found dumped on the Panipat-Jind rail track on January 12, 2008. As the blood trail led to a nearby field, the GRP registered a case under Section 302 of the IPC but the body was identified only a week later by the victim's family on the basis of a photograph in a newspaper. A year later, the police are still groping in the dark on the motive and the identity of the killers. They suspect two youths whom the victim's family knows and who have been absconding ever since. Rambir's young widow Pooja and father Pushe Lal and mother Rameshwari Devi—originally natives of the Shahjahanpur district in Uttar Pradesh—had migrated to Panipat to eke out a living.

They are too poor to pursue the case and apprehend that a court case would deny them their daily wages. "We have lost our sole bread-earner and will gain nothing from the court case," says Rameshwari who has resigned to her fate.

Such conundrum is all the more evident in cases where the police suspect the complicity of the victim's family in the murder on the railway track. Kuldeep Singh's body was found on the tracks in Hisar on March 31, 2006. His hands were tied when he was thrown on the railway track where a train severed his head from the torso. The 30-year-old bachelor, son of a farmer in Hasangarh village in Jind, used to run a post office in the village and had left his home a day before telling his family that he was going out to collect money from someone in the nearby town. "We have no enmity with anyone in the village or elsewhere," says his mother Manan Devi. However, investigations by the Crime Branch of the Haryana Police point to his family's involvement as they show little interest in pursuing the case. "Our dilemma is that the family cannot be subjected to interrogation because it is the complainant," says a GRP official.

The suspicion that many of

▲ MANJU AND MITHILESH
FARIDABAD, HARYANA
 Their mutilated bodies were recovered on December 18 last year. Initially labelled suicides, medical examination revealed they had been raped.

"They were murdered and then thrown on the tracks to cover up the crime."
GANGA RAM, GRANDFATHER

ANOMALIES
 In many cases, the results of police investigations are negated by forensic tests which clearly establish murder.